

Requests, Country Engagement & Outreach

Generated: 2026-06-25 | Entries: 17

Q: Please provide the new overall capacity-development strategy

DESA is requested to provide the response

The United Nations Development Assistance is guided by the relevant mandates particularly General Assembly resolution 71/243 on the quadrennial comprehensive policy review (QCPR), and resolution 72/279 on the repositioning of UN development system. Three years after this resolution, the UN development system is better positioned to play this role and respond more effectively and nimbly to the needs of Member States. The reinvigorated role of the resident coordinator system and a new generation of UN country teams brings the expertise of the entire UN system – including non-resident secretariat entities – to mitigate the socio-economic impact of the pandemic and to support national development priorities. The Regular Programme of Technical Cooperation is rather small in monetary terms, but it provides countries a crucial access to the expertise available in the 11 global and regional implementing entities. The RPTC's main feature is that it is demand-driven, funding the short-term immediate assistance to country demands building on the expertise available in the respective implementing entity. The resident coordinator in the respective countries ensure that support to the country is provided by the Organization that is most suited for the requested support, complementing the resources available in the UN country team. The United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Framework is the most important instrument for planning and implementation of the UN development activities at country level. This is in line with Member States' call for a UN development reform to boost coordination to support countries to achieve the 2030 Agenda.

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Q: Please list in a table the specific country request for technical assistance in the last two years per continent.

All entities please provide the requested information in the excel spreadsheet provided.

DESA: Table 9 provided

In 2020, DESA launched a revised version of its central demand repository with the aim of comprehensively and timely capturing requests across DESA's divisions. All direct requests for RPTC support are entered in this repository and the progress of activities is monitored on a quarterly basis. Furthermore, the new RPTC guidelines which were issued in early 2020, require a record of the request in the demand repository to allow funding of the response, unless in exceptional cases, the activity constitutes piloting a new approach/tool or relates to an initial scoping mission. Since January 2020 DESA received over 100 requests from Member States for capacity building support. The requests came mostly from Asia and Africa with 44 and 45 requests received, respectively. These are direct requests for DESA's capacity development support from Member States (i.e., ministries, departments, Permanent Missions, etc.) as well as referrals from UN Resident

Coordinators, country teams, regional commissions, and other UN agencies. Some requests are identified through processes such as the Voluntary National Reviews (VNR) or Common Country Assessments (CCA) or direct mandates through the intergovernmental bodies.

Please note that the requests submitted are from the years 2020 and 2021 which coincide with the issuance of the new RPTC guidelines and the revamped Repository of capacity development demands. DESA has no readily available data for 2019.

For more information on the specific requests, please see Annex Q9 list of requests from Member States

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Q: How is the impact of RPTC-financed programmes assessed and their long-term sustainability determined?

DESA is requested to provide the response based on the verbal responses from Mr. Harris.

The regular programme of technical cooperation delivers complex multidimensional capacity development approaches responding to needs expressed by Member States and by regional and sub-regional cooperation groups for advice on policy options and strengthening institutional frameworks and for support in relation to policy debates on new and emerging issues. Knowledge building and skills development continue to be valued by Governments as an effective mechanism for strengthening national capacity for policy development.

The defining feature of the programme is that it must be demand driven, responding to an expressed need by Member States for capacity development support. At the same time, to ensure that RPTC services complement and promote the implementing entities overall strategic priorities, they cannot be solely delivered on an ad-hoc basis but are part of more complex programmatic approaches based on a thorough understanding and appreciation of national needs.

One of the fundamental features of the regular programme of technical cooperation is its utility in linking initial assistance provided under the programme with better-endowed funds to generate large-scale benefits. The regular programme of technical cooperation implementing entities, whose initiatives are often short-term in nature, have fostered a range of coordinated and collaborative approaches with other entities and within the entities themselves through mechanisms such as parallel programming, joint programming, harmonized initiatives, and increasingly the application of an integrated programme approach where regular programme of technical cooperation-funded advisory services have been utilized in conjunction with larger programmes. Leveraging of regular programme of technical cooperation resources through planned linkages with the Development Account and extra-budgetary resources creates multiplier effects which contribute to longer-term, sustained impacts. Intervention at country-level is coordinated with the UN Resident Coordinator and the UN country teams to ensure synergies with the country-level development work. This cooperation can include joint programming through the common country assessment, the United Nations Development Assistance

Framework and the Poverty Reduction Strategy process.

The monitoring, reporting and evaluation plan of the Cooperation Framework at the country level is developed at the Cooperation design phase and include annual reviews and annual UN country results. And the final Cooperation Framework evaluation. The assessment it at the Cooperation Framework level and while results from RPTC funded activities may be captured, no separate evaluation of the specific intervention or contribution of activities funded by the RPTC is undertaken.

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Q: How is the work plan and corresponding resources determined if as noted in paragraph 23.4 the program responds to requests by the Member States? JS - done

DESA is requested to provide the response based on the verbal responses from Mr. Harris.

The proposed programme budget outlines in broad terms the specific sectoral areas which will be addressed through the work of the implementing entities. When receiving requests for assistance, and in defining their annual programme of work, all entities draw from the criteria indicated in paragraph 23.13 of the proposed programme budget A/74/6 (Sect 23), to assess individual projects which will be pursued under the RPTC.

Requests for assistance are received either through (i) direct communication from the countries or from the Resident Coordinator; (ii) demand expressed through workshops/seminars, where the need for future interventions, or follow up activities are planned; and (iii) demand expressed through the functional commissions, where the need to strengthen countries knowledge in specific areas is articulated. The relevant entities analyse the requests and determine how best to respond to them, including whether such requests for services are within their mandated area of expertise, whether the services can be carried out within the coming period, and the relevant source of funding to support that action. The entities may also define an annual integrated work plan for capacity development, which outlines all capacity development activities to be implemented during the year, funded under the RPTC, Development Account and extra-budgetary funding, to ensure better coordination and utilization of resources across these three funding sources.

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Q: In that RPTC's defining feature is that it is self-driven, are there other systematic means other than word-of-mouth and face-to-face meetings with government officials for member states to made aware of the options and possibilities for access to RPTC-supported programmes (para. 23.31)? What roles do implementing agencies, OHRLLS and the Resident Coordinator system play in raising the awareness of Member States?

DESA is requested to provide the response based on the verbal responses from Mr. Harris.

The Development Policy Branch (DPB) of DESA coordinates closely with OHRLLS on issues related to LDCs, including the coordination of capacity development activities to countries graduating from the LDC category. DPB actively participates in the Inter-Agency Task Force (IATF) for graduating LDCs (chaired/lead by OHRLLS), which coordinates activities for these countries among the United Nations Development System (UNDS) and other international organisations working on LDC issues. For instance, in 2019 OHRLLS and DESA worked closely in the organization and implementation of joint IATF missions to Solomon Islands and Sao Tome & Principe. The implementing entities also engage with the Resident Coordinator and resident agencies to maximize the impact of country-level development work. Such cooperation enables access to up-to-date information on national development priorities and better positioning in the broader development cooperation environment. The RPTC fills a crucial funding gap allowing developing countries to access the expertise of nonresident entities to address capacity development needs that cannot be met by the resident agencies on the ground. It is embedded and complemented by the renewed United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Framework supported by the UN country teams. While countries may approach the implementing entities directly, capacity development interventions at country-level are coordinated with the UN country team through the Resident Coordinator.

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Q: Please provide details on the resource requirements for the increased outreach activities.

All entities – please provide the relevant information if available in the excel table provided

DESA

Effective outreach activities will continue to be a core priority for DESA's capacity development work in 2022.

As previously mentioned, a lot of the outreach happens during strategic events and connection opportunities such as through intergovernmental meetings, conferences including during meetings of the RCs. Specifically, for outreach to RCs, DESA has created a Senior Advisor position to facilitate exchanges and ensure that DESA's CD offering as well as needs at country level are exchanged and aligned.

In addition, DESA uses its divisional websites as well as its capacity development website to communicate DESA's projects and activities, invite Member States to submit interest or requests for support and inform audiences about important updates.

In 2022, DESA will make strategic investments in its e-learning, communications and outreach infrastructure supporting divisions in their digital capacity development and learning delivery including outreach, so that good practices can be scaled and colleagues have the insights, community, skills and

tools they need to design and lead meaningful digital engagements with their partners and beneficiaries. At the same time, communication efforts will be increased and more targeted, allowing a dialogue with Member States and RCs that allows continuous improvement and alignment of DESA's CD portfolio. This will be achieved through increased use of social media as well as targeted virtual outreach activities, in addition to the existing modalities mentioned above. The additional outreach activities will largely be provided by existing staff complemented by limited consultancy services funded by RPTC to enhance communication with Member States.

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Q: Please provide the number of LDCs which were reached with the outreach activities –

All entities, please provide the relevant information in the excel tables provided

DESA: DESA facilitates major global conferences and summits in the economic, social, and environmental fields where the Department conducts outreach activities at the margins of these strategic intergovernmental events about its capacity development offerings and how it can help Member States in translating the 2030 Agenda and other relevant global policy frameworks into viable and effective national strategies, policies, and programmes. Due to its limited resources, UN DESA focuses on priority countries such as Least Developed Countries, Small Island Development States, and Landlocked Developing Countries which are all represented at the global meetings. UN DESA also conduct numerous capacity development activities at national and global levels where it communicates its offerings to Member States for country-level support.

For more information on the number of outreach activities to LDCs, please see Annex Q27a, Q28 and Q29 outreach information.

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Q: DESA Please provide more detailed information on standard operating procedures for country-level engagement in the context of the new RC system.

11.1 The implementing entities (IEs) of the RPTC are, in principle, following the United Nation's management accountability framework (MAF), which clarifies that the resident coordinator (RC) is responsible for the coordination of operational activities for development of the UN in support of countries' efforts towards implementation of the 2030 Agenda and sets out relationships between RCOs and IEs, especially when IEs are members of the UNCT. Cooperation with UNCTs and RCOs is strong across the board.

11.2 DESA's current approach to country-level support, including RPTC funded interventions, is fully aligned with the new role and functions of the RC system. RPTC-funded activities are triggered by direct government requests for DESA expertise, or by RC requests on behalf of the government to address capacity development needs that cannot be fulfilled by regional or UNCT entities. The implementation of DESA RPTC-funded activities is governed by standard operating procedures for country-level engagement in the context of the new RC system. ECE has developed threefold communication streams with RCOs and UNCTs, including regular presentations on ECE portfolios in 17 UN programme countries through participation in the UNCT meetings; briefings for RCOs and UNCTs on existing tools, instruments, ongoing projects and identification of new entry points for joint programming, and joint ECE-ESCAP presentations on tools available in both Regional Commissions for programme countries with dual memberships. ECLAC's subregional and national offices fully participate in the UNCTs work and provide direct support, input and data on economic and social development perspectives to the RCOs and UNCTs. ECLAC has actively increased its support to UNCTs through different mechanisms such as provision of advice, development of an inception programme for RCs, the UN economists' network, and communication on upcoming travel by staff to the respective countries.

11.3 Resident Coordinators are regularly invited to intergovernmental meetings and meetings of the subsidiary bodies to share lessons learned, experiences and identify areas for mutual technical assistance and cooperation to advance on the implementation of the 2030 Agenda. ECA is currently reviewing its strategy on engaging with RCOs and UNCTs, building on lessons learned from the current strategy, with a view to strengthening tailored support to country-level UN action and thereby accelerating SDG and Agenda 2063 implementation. ESCAP's sub-regional offices also participate in

the UNCTs in their sub-region, as appropriate.

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Q: Please indicate how applications are made for support and how countries get to know about the requests they can make to RPTC.

29.1 Requests for assistance are received either through (i) direct communication from the countries or from the Resident Coordinator; (ii) demand expressed through workshops/seminars, where the need for future interventions, or follow up activities are planned, and; (iii) demand expressed through the functional commissions, where the need to strengthen countries knowledge in specific areas is articulated. The relevant entities analyse the requests and determine how best to respond to them, including whether such requests for services are within their mandated area of expertise, whether the services can be carried out within the upcoming period, and whether the RPTC would be the most relevant source of funding to support respective actions.

29.2 For example, DESA leverages many different engagement channels to promote the RPTC. Its website provides information on its projects, approach and funding modalities and houses an interactive map as well as audiovisual material. Targeted engagement with government officials (including Permanent Representatives) from developing countries also takes place in the context of intergovernmental meetings, conferences, and workshops (e.g., via sessions of the Annual UN Forum on Forests, the UN Tax Committee, the Annual Commission on Population and Development, and many others). Given the demand-driven nature of the RPTC, raising awareness of DESA's offering for Member States is an integral component of all its communications.

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Q: Please remind the Committee on how the amounts to be presented in Section 23 are defined, in particular the allocation between IEs.

8.1 The level of approved resources for the RPTC entities is determined by the General Assembly during the budgetary review process. The Secretary-General proposes the resources for the subsequent period using the approved resources for the current period as the initial starting point. The Fifth Committee will then make a recommendation to the General Assembly on the resources for budget sections, which may take into consideration any recommendation from the Advisory Committee. Once the General Assembly adopts its resolution on the proposed programme budget (such as A/RES/77/262), the Secretariat allocates the approved level of resources to the various implementing entities in line with the appropriation.

8.2 In the proposed budget for 2024, the Secretary-General has proposed an overall increase of

\$1,500,000 for 2024 compared with the appropriation for 2023. The increase is intended to address the expected increase in requests for support in 2024. For DESA, there is a higher increase proposed for 2024 of 5.8%, to bring the allocated share for DESA closer in line to previous years following a reduction in 2023. The other implementing entities have been proposed with the same percentage increase of 2.8% for 2024.

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Q: Please provide more detailed information, by entity on the process by which it can receive requests for assistance. Is there a formal process to register the requests? What is the role of the resident coordinators in that process? Is it official?

DESA

10.1 For the sectoral advisory services implementing entities (DESA, UNCTAD, UN Habitat, UNODC, OHCHR and OCHA), the process in DESA will be used as an example. In DESA, the requests for assistance are received either through (i) direct communication from the countries or from the Resident Coordinator; (ii) demand expressed through workshops/seminars, where the need for future interventions, or follow up activities are planned; and (iii) demand expressed through the functional commissions, where the need to strengthen countries knowledge in specific areas is articulated. The relevant entities analyse the requests and determine how best to respond to them, including whether such requests for services are within their mandated area of expertise, whether the services can be carried out within the coming period, and the relevant source of funding to support that action. For example, DESA maintains a request log that aims to ensure that direct country requests for capacity development assistance are recorded systematically and acted on. All direct country requests communicated to DESA should be entered in the requests log. Funding sources such as the Regular Programme of Technical Cooperation (RPTC), give higher priority to activities that respond to a direct country request.

ECA

10.2 ECA receives requests for support from several channels. Mostly, requests are received in writing from member States. Most of the national requests received are addressed to the Executive Secretary and a few are addressed directly to the Divisions or Sub-Regional Offices responsible for providing the support. Requests are also received during intergovernmental processes such as from the Conference of African Ministers of Finance, Planning and Economic Development through adopted resolutions and recommendations. Requests are also received from the different subsidiary organs of the intergovernmental structure. Further, requests are received through meetings of senior leadership with representatives of member States, and these are usually followed by written requests.

10.3 In terms of the role of RCs, ECA coordinates with the resident coordinator system and the UN country teams when responding to requests and delivering support to member States. RCs help to set the scene for national workshops, and they participate as discussants, ensuring they have a firm understanding of the Integrated Planning and Reporting Tool and its applications in their country

context. The ECA strategy document on collaboration with RCOs and UNCTs is clear on how ECA should coordinate with RCOs and UNCTs on its activities, projects, and programmes. The strategy provides direction and focus to ECA cooperation and collaboration with Resident Coordinators/UN Country Teams with a view to strengthening tailored and value-adding support to country-level UN action in the region.

ECLAC

10.4 All RPTC support delivered by ECLAC is provided in response to formal requests by the beneficiary member States from the Latin American and Caribbean region. These requests may be channelled through specific requests, in the context of bilateral meetings with senior authorities, intergovernmental meetings or through other activities implemented by the Commission. These informal settings are better suited for an initial assessment of a country's needs and an attempt to match them with in-house expertise. In line with the demand-driven nature of the RPTC, ECLAC raises awareness of the opportunities for Latin American and Caribbean countries to access technical support from the regular programme resources through outreach and ECLAC notifications and announcements on various training and capacity building offerings, in addition to face-to-face meetings with government officials, including permanent representatives, of the countries of the region. RPTC requests are afterwards sent to the substantive division responsible for the respective thematic area that will afterwards deliver the support requested.

10.5 ECLAC collaborates with RCs and RCOs, in some cases informing them of the activities that take place, in others engaging with them for the organization of the activities. In this regard, there is a system to regularly inform RCs on a specific mission that is taking place, and to inform and consult with RCs when their active participation is required.

ESCAP

10.6 ESCAP can receive requests for capacity development support from member States in several ways:

Requests sent in writing from governments or subregional intergovernmental organizations to ESCAP offices (e.g., substantive divisions or subregional offices)

Bilateral meetings with the Executive Secretary and other senior managers with policy makers from member States

Outcome documents/reports of intergovernmental meetings such as Ministerial Conferences/Committee sessions and decisions/resolutions endorsed by the Commission

Requests raised and recorded in various meetings, e.g., expert group meetings, seminars/workshops and during missions

10.7 The submission of the requests hence is not centralized but for all RPTC proposals they are collected by the Strategy and Programme Management Division, as part of the justification process. All RPTC funded activities can be traced to expressed demand from member States through the above channels. ESCAP holds semi-annual consultations with all substantive divisions and offices where issues related to country demand for support and alignment of resources are taken up.

10.8 As for the role of RCOs, they facilitate the transmission of requests from member States. Such requests have to originate from member States and not from an RCO itself. The above policy on receiving RPTC requests is articulated in ESCAP guidelines on RPTC.

ESCWA

10.9 ESCWA receives requests for assistance through official letters addressed to its Executive Secretary; through emails addressed to its technical cooperation team; through emails addressed to heads of subprogrammes; through emails addressed to its implementing staff; and through oral

requests made during high-level visits to its Executive Secretary. ESCWA has a form for requesting technical cooperation services, and most requests are received through filling out the form, which specifies the type of services required and the activities they entail. Upon the receipt of a request, after virtual discussions with the requester on its scope and the required expertise, an in-house discussion is held to see whether ESCWA can respond to the request and has the needed budget to execute the activities. If the response is positive, ESCWA registers the request in its dedicated portal, which also serves to update the status, record the activities and accompanying documents, and provide reporting information.

10.10 Upon registration in that portal, the resident coordinator' office in the relevant country is notified through an automatic email sent through the portal, which contains the title of the request, the requesting entity, and the fact that ESCWA is ready to provide more information if requested.

UNECE

10.11 Requests for assistance received through: (a) official letters for assistance (either from the government or from the RC); (b) intergovernmental meetings; (c) reports of capacity-building activities (in case further follow up activities are requested). UNECE collects all requests based on what project implementation is authorized. Tracking system is being established. UNECE has also an internal RPTC directive to guide RPTC implementation in the organization.

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Q: In reference to paragraph 23.9 and in context of the overall management of the Programme, how are decisions made? Where are they made? Who makes the determination of what to be included in the fascicle?

15.1 The management of the RPTC programme is guided by the reforms of the United Nations development system. The Secretary-General's report A/75/79 provides a thorough update on the implementation of the 2016 quadrennial comprehensive policy review and the reforms of the United Nations development system.

15.2 Each entity follows the guidance in the decision concerning the management of the programme. As an example, DESA has implemented standard operating procedures (please refer to the response provided for question 11, above) to ensure coordination of its country-level activities with the Resident Coordinator (RC) and the UN country team. At the global-level, the Executive Committee on Economic and Social Affairs (ECESA), inter-alia, helps to agree on division of labour among the participating entities. Inter-Agency taskforces and working groups, such as the Inter-Agency Task Force on Financing for Development (<https://developmentfinance.un.org/>) or the Intersecretariat Working Group on Environment Statistics (<https://unstats.un.org/unsd/envstats/coordination.cshtml>) provide fora to ensure well-coordinated responses to development challenges on sectoral topics. Thus, the established internal mechanism referenced in paragraph 23.9 include conceptual coordination through the ECESA, country level coordination through the RC/RCO and sector/topic coordination through respective taskforces and working groups.

Q: The coordination achieved through the Executive Committee on Economic and Social Affairs and engagement through the United Nations Sustainable Development Group are well-noted. Where and how is the final decision made on the projects to be included in the RPTC's work plan (paragraph 23.9, page 4), bearing in mind, in particular, the indication under a number of sub-programmes of the challenge of addressing a growing number of requests for support?

Requests for support from Member States' governments are prioritized by the respective subprogramme in coordination with the programme office in the respective entity (such as the Capacity Development Programme Management Office (CDPMO) in the case of DESA). Requests are vetted in view of the capacity in the subprogramme as well as to provide priority to LDCs, LLDCs and SIDS. In cases where the demand exceeds the available capacity, the substantive office, in consultation with CDPMO and the Office of the Under-Secretary-General, may provide a scaled down support, such as provide peer review of the national development plans and strategies without actively participating in the implementation. Where common needs for capacity development are shared by multiple countries, regional and global level workshops are organized to ensure synergy and to be able to respond in view of limited internal capacity in the secretariat. 24 Considering the importance of repositioning of the Development system in supporting the development agenda, please explain: 24a. how all activities under the agenda are interlinked and coordinated? 24a.1 The 2030 Agenda provides a coherent and indivisible agreement. For example, there is no 'pick-and-choose' approach between the SDGs. The UN system provides support to Member States with the implementation of the Agenda at the global, regional and national level. Since the repositioning of the development system, these three pillars (global, regional and national) have moved closer together. 24a.2 Departments with a more global reach, such as DESA, UNCTAD, UN-Habitat, UNODC and OHCHR are not present at the country level and access national level resources through the Resident Coordinator system. 24a.3 As an example of the coordination by entities, in DESA, the Capacity Development Programme Management Office (CDPMO), supports eight subprogrammes in the development and implementation of a more coordinated and integrated approach for capacity development work, drawing upon the Department's normative and analytical strengths and comparative advantages. CDPMO has facilitated the overall coordination, management and administration of DESA's capacity development activities as well as provided guidance and quality assurance in their implementation to ensure increased accountability and efficient delivery. Furthermore, to address the challenges of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and the Addis Ababa Action Agenda (AAAA), CDPMO coordinated a departmental internal review of its approach to capacity development with a view to better aligning DESA's efforts in this area with the emerging capacity development demand from Member States. As a result, DESA adopted a new Strategy for Capacity Development in March 2016.

Q: Does DESA have a dedicated unit to support this coordination?

24c.1 DESA does not have a dedicated unit that manages the implementation of the repositioning of the development system. However, given the importance of the initiative, the Office of the USG of DESA has taken on a coordinating role across the subprogrammes. The Department has established a network of divisional focal points to serve as the backbone for DESA's support to the reinvigorated RC system.

24c.2 The Development Policy Branch (DPB) is the coordinator of the capacity development activities of the Division. DPB is also the Secretariat of the Committee for Development Policy (CDP). The CDP Secretariat services the CDP which is mandated to maintain the list of LDCs and identify countries for inclusion and graduation from the list. DPB is often requested by DESA to function as the focal point on LDC-related issues. As such, DPB is in a unique position to coordinate DESA's work on LDCs with OHRLLS.

26 Section 23 has been resources under Regular Budget. Do you make efforts to mobilize extra-budgetary resources?

26.1 Implementing entities may link pilot activities supported by RPTC with the Development Account and extra-budgetary resources. For example, advisory missions undertaken under the RPTC may lead to the establishment of Development Account projects which provide a natural platform to pursue longer term and sustainable support to countries. This serves to enhance the multiplier effects which contribute to longer-term, sustained impact.

26.2 Similarly, the seed activities under RPTC funding may lead to larger scale project proposals to extra-budgetary resources funding such as the 2030 Agenda for sustainable development sub-fund. In addition, RPTC funding often complements extrabudgetary projects implemented by UNDP or other resident agencies, whereas RPTC funding provides advice on policy, approaches and methodology. One example for that approach is the funding of Integrated National Financing Framework (INFF), whereas DESA works closely with UNDP and the EU to advance the INFF concept in 16 pioneer countries and some 60 UN country teams have integrated SDG financing strategies in projects to be funded from the joint SDG fund. Further details of this example can be found at the following link: <https://jointsdgfund.org/>.

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Q: Please provide further information on how the RPTC filters the requests from Member States if there is already capacity in the countries? What if there is duplication with other agencies? What is the process to get the assistance of RPTC? With reference to other entities such as UNEP, IAEA, etc. do you check with them?

46.1 The proposed programme budget outlines in broad terms the specific sectoral areas which will be addressed through the work of the subprogrammes. When receiving requests for assistance from Member States, and in defining their annual programme of work, all implementing entities draw from the following criteria (para 23.13) to assess individual projects which will be pursued under the RPTC:

- Activities should be responsive to the request of developing countries and be of a short-term nature.

- Activities should fall within the implementing entity's priority areas as mandated by its governing body and on which the implementing entity plays a demonstrate a leadership role in normative and analytical functions.

- Activities should build capacity in developing countries, including for meeting treaty and related normative obligations and through feedback of experience gained at the country level, enrich the analytical functions of the implementing entity for the benefit of all Member States.

- Activities that aid in the preparation of specialized components of a country's development strategy or that help to prepare requests for larger-scale funding from other sources.

46.2 Drawing on DESA as an illustration, it has defined its capacity development work in five distinct areas which are interlinked:

- Policy coherence

- Social inclusion

- Institutions and integrated inclusive approaches

- Evidence based policy

- Means of implementation

46.3 See paragraph 2.2 above which details how requests for assistance are received. The figure below is a chart of the different stakeholders (including implementing entities, the Resident Coordinators and the country teams), showing how they interact.

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Q: Question 5. Please provide more information of what can constitute an advisory service under RPTC and how, in case of virtual provision of advisory services, is it possible to differentiate what form of assistance is offered in this type of support in comparison to regular consultation and advice as part of your programme of work? What is the criteria used to determine what kind of advisory service can be qualified for financing under technical cooperation?

4.1 The implementing entities advisory services respond to requests from Governments for advice on policy related issues, provide specific advice on sectoral matters relevant to their development strategies and programmes and assist governments in the formulation and evaluation of programmes leading to the enhancement of national programmes. The entity that received the

request will review whether the request falls within its area of competence and falls under its mandate. The response would be planned as to build capacity in the national entity or entities in the respective area. In-person advice may not always be necessary, particularly when the implementing entity has built a working relationship with the respective governmental institutions. However, the modality of advisory mission (in-person) is of much value for having initial discussions, identify needs and plan future capacity building interventions as well as validating some results of ongoing interventions. The objective and thematic area of the advisory or technical support, coupled with the profile and previous experience with the target government institutions help determine the modality of delivery. For instance, on-the-job training may require in-person delivery, especially in technical areas such as statistics. Similarly, policy support that necessitates consultations among various stakeholders is better organized in person.

4.2 The implementing entities support the building of networks and can often respond to follow-up queries electronically, bring together practitioner from various countries or provide advice at the side of existing events and workshops. Technical advisory services are coordinated through with the Resident Coordinator's Office (RCO), ensuring connections with the relevant UN entities in the country.

4.3 For example, in DESA, the Inter regional Advisers (IRAs) have reported that a growing portion of their time has been dedicated to providing virtual advisory services and support to Member States. In fact, many IRAs report a significant increase in their advisory services, given the new global acceptance and use of virtual consultations, advisory services and peer reviews. Rather than waiting to embark on a physical mission, IRAs have been able to cater to a high volume of requests for advisory services, supporting different time zones and more meetings as previously experienced due to a renewed sense of "around the clock availability" and responsiveness.

4.4 However, Member States have consistently underscored the importance of the provision of face-to-face advisory services. The suitability of the use of virtual advisory may vary according to the nature of the advisory service requested. In many instances, advisors work with national counterparts on sensitive data and information that can only be accessed on site. There are also confidential discussions that take place with national counterparts to ensure the effective delivery of the advisory service and these discussions can only take place in person.

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